# Cheng Chen

Prospective PhD Applicant

**Tongji University · Electrical Engineering**

2351445@tongji.edu.cn
chenceason10@gmail.com
ceasonen.github.io
github.com/ceasonen
Major rank 3/87
Shanghai, China



## Summary

- EE undergrad at Tongji (rank **3/87**). Research on **multimodal AI** and **trustworthy AI**.
- Looking for PhD opportunities in these areas.
- Accepted papers at **ACM MM**, **IJCAI**, **IJCNN**, **ICANN** (2 oral); submission to **NeurIPS**.

## Education

**B.Eng. in Electrical Engineering, Tongji University**, Shanghai — 2023.09 – Present
Major rank: **3/87**; CET-6: **519**.

## Research

**If You Hear It, Help Find It: Orthogonal Knowledge Distillation for Open-Vocabulary Audio-Visual Event Localization** — ACM MM 2026
Y. Xu*, **C. Chen***, W. Lei. **Accepted; co-first; oral.**
Open-vocabulary audio-visual event localization with orthogonal knowledge distillation.

**OrthKD: Extracting Generalized Clinical Knowledge from Heterogeneous Teachers for Lightweight Deployment** — IJCAI 2026
**C. Chen***, Y. Xu*, M. Cao. **Accepted; co-first (listed first); oral.**
Distill multiple clinical models into one small model without inheriting each teacher's bias.

**Enabling Visual Reasoning in Text-Only LLMs via Symbolic Scene Descriptions** — IJCNN 2026
W. Lei, M. Cao, C. Ye, Y. Xu, **C. Chen**. **Accepted; corresponding author.**
Describe scenes in symbols so text-only LLMs can reason about images.

**Beyond Relevance: Counter-Evidence Planning in a Controlled Budgeted RAG Testbed** — ICANN 2026
Y. Cai, Y. Xu, **C. Chen**. **Accepted; corresponding author.**
Plan retrieval under a fixed budget, including evidence that might disagree.

**Neural-Operator Risk Assessment for Deployable Risk Triage** — NeurIPS 2026
**C. Chen** et al. **Under review; first author.**
Flag risky neural-operator outputs in one forward pass.

## Awards

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| Provincial First Prize, China Robot and Artificial Intelligence Competition | 2026 |
| National 2nd Prize, Global Campus AI Algorithm Elite Competition | 2025 |
| National 3rd Prize, Embedded Chip & System Design Competition, FPGA track | 2025 |
| Shanghai 3rd Prize, National Mathematical Modeling Competition | 2025 |
| Shanghai 3rd Prize, National Statistical Modeling Competition | 2025 |
| Provincial 2nd Prize, National College Student Mathematics Competition (CMC) | 2024, 2025 |
| Tongji University Outstanding Student Scholarship | 2023–2024, 2024–2025 |

## Skills

- **Experience:** Familiar with common research workflows and tools, including **Python**, **PyTorch**, **Git**, **LaTeX**, experiment tracking, and LLM/agent prototyping for literature review, coding, and analysis.
- **Writing:** English level sufficient to read and understand research papers; familiar with the focus, process, and logic of both academic writing and project writing.
- **Passion:** Genuinely enthusiastic about learning and exploration, and eager to push into areas I have not worked in yet.
- **Outside lab:** Football (Barça & Arsenal), cycling, music.